

Route groups — (group)

Live demos: `/about` (in `(marketing)`) and `/cart` (in `(store)`) **Code:** `src/app/(marketing)/` and `src/app/(store)/`

This guide covers **both** groups in this lab.

What it is

Wrapping a folder name in **parentheses** — `(marketing)`, `(store)` — creates a **route group**. The group name is used only for organization and is **omitted from the URL**.

File	URL	The group adds to the path?
<code>app/(marketing)/about/page.tsx</code>	<code>/about</code>	no
<code>app/(store)/cart/page.tsx</code>	<code>/cart</code>	no

What it's for

1. **Organize routes** by team/section/intent without changing URLs (marketing pages vs shop pages vs admin).
2. **Give a subset of routes their own layout.** In this lab `(marketing)` and `(store)` each have a **different layout.tsx**, even though both live at the URL root. Notice the accent color differs between `/about` and `/cart`.
3. Opt specific routes into (or out of) a shared layout/loading skeleton without nesting the URL.

Related: multiple root layouts

If you remove the top-level `app/layout.tsx` and give **each group its own root layout** (with its own `<html>` / `<body>`), you get *multiple root layouts* — totally separate shells. Because that conflicts with this lab's single shared shell, it's demonstrated in its own app: `examples/multiple-root-layouts/`.

Gotcha

Don't create two routes that resolve to the **same URL** in different groups (e.g. a `(a)/page.tsx` and `(b)/page.tsx` both mapping to `/`) — that's a conflict.

Interview Q&A

- **Q: Does (group) affect the URL?** No. Parentheses are stripped from the path; they're purely organizational.
- **Q: Give a real reason to use route groups.** To apply different layouts to different sections that share the same URL level (e.g. a marketing shell vs an app shell), or to scope a `loading.tsx` to just some routes.